

Enfys and the Golden Treasure



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Lauren E Matthews asserts the moral right to be identified as the author of this work.

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Foreword

A Note to the Mams and Dads

The story of *Enfys and the Golden Treasure* was inspired by the idea that bravery isn't always found in fire and scales, sometimes, it's found in a soft heart and the courage to be oneself.

In a world that often tells us to be “tough,” Enfys represents the strength found in vulnerability. As you read this story with your child, you might want to explore these themes together:

Embracing Uniqueness: Enfys is physically different from the other dragons, having soft, white, curly fur instead of scales. His journey shows that our differences are often our greatest strengths.

The “Secret” Kindness: You'll notice that the larger dragons, Flint, Ember, and Slate are actually very kind, but they act tough because they are afraid of being laughed at. This is a wonderful opening to talk about peer pressure and why it's okay to be “soft” out in the open.

The Real Value of Treasure: While Enfys guards a vault of gold, he learns that the real “treasure” is the kindness we show to others.

A Little Fun with the Name

As mentioned in the preface, **Enfys** (pronounced *En-viss*) is the Welsh word for “Rainbow.” Just like the author, Lauren E Matthews, who lives in the mountains of the Rhondda valley in Wales, Enfys brings a little bit of magic and colour to the Fireback Mountains.

We hope you and your little dragons enjoy the journey!

Preface

Welcome to the Fireback Mountains!

Before you begin your adventure with our very special dragon, there is something you should know about his name. Our hero is named **Enfys**.

In the real world, Enfys is a name from Wales, a country famous for its green valleys and stories of dragons. In the Welsh language, **Enfys means “Rainbow.”**

Just like a rainbow appearing after a storm, our Enfys brings light and colour to everyone he meets.

Because it might look a little tricky to say at first, here is a guide to help you say it just like a dragon would:

How to say it: En-viss

Rhymes with: Miss

Enfys is not your typical dragon. While others have sharp, cold scales, he has soft, white, curly fur with tips that shimmer like gold. He reminds us that you don’t have to be “tough” to be brave, and that being kind is the most powerful magic of all.

So, shake out your curls, find a cosy spot, and get ready to discover why being different is the greatest treasure of all.



Enfys the curly furred dragon.

The Little Dragon Who Was Different

High in the Fireback Mountains, many dragons lived among the clouds. They were tall and strong, and their shiny scales sparkled in the sun when they flew.

But, in a small cave near the edge of the mountain, lived a very unusual dragon.

His name was Enfys, which means rainbow in the old dragon language.

Enfys was much smaller than the other dragons. And instead of scales, his body was covered in soft, white, curly fur. The tips of his curls even shimmered gold in the sunlight.

When the wind blew, his curls bounced.

Enfys liked helping others. He helped carry firewood, looked after younger dragons, and squeezed into small places to rescue anyone stuck.

But the other dragons didn't understand him.

Sometimes, when Enfys walked by, they laughed.

“Dragons don’t have fur!” they said.

“You look like a sheep with wings!”

At night, Enfys sometimes felt sad. He wished he looked like everyone else.

He wondered why his heart felt warm when he helped others, even when they didn’t understand him.

But every morning, he shook out his curls and went out to help again.

Because helping others made him happy.

THE LITTLE DRAGON WHO WAS DIFFERENT



Enfys shakes out his bouncy curls, ready to help anyone who needs him. Ember, Slate and Flint are planning a race.

The Dragons Who Teased Him

The dragons who teased Enfys were called Flint, Ember, and Slate.

Flint was green and strong. Ember was bright red and loud. Slate was white and tall and quiet.

They liked to act tough and brave all the time.

Sometimes they laughed at Enfys' curly fur. And sometimes that made Enfys' heart hurt.

But even when they teased him, Enfys still helped them when they needed it.

One morning, Flint, Ember, and Slate decided they would race to the peak of the mountain.

"You can't come Enfys!" Ember shouted, her red scales glowing in the morning sun.

"Your fur will catch the wind like a big fluffy sail!"

Enfys tried to keep up, but the wind puffed into his curls, slowing him down.

He landed on a ledge, feeling sad.

But then, he heard a tiny cheep. A mountain chick was shivering in the cold. Enfys tucked the baby bird into his warm, soft curls.

“I might not be fast,” Enfys whispered, “but I am cosy.”

He wished the others could feel how warm and right it felt to help others.

While Enfys sat warming the little bird, he thought about all the times the bigger dragons had laughed at him, and he wondered, “Why do they act this way?”

He didn’t know the answer yet.

But soon, he would find out.



Too slow to keep up, Enfys found something far more important. A tiny, cold chick who needed the warmth only his curls could give.

What Enfys Saw

One evening, Enfys was flying home when he saw Flint doing something surprising.

Flint was helping an old dragon carry heavy firewood to her cave. When she turned to say thank you, Flint quickly flew away so she wouldn't see him.

Another night, Enfys saw Ember leave a basket of food outside the cave of a sick dragon before sneaking off.

And early one morning, Enfys saw Slate fixing a broken toy and leaving it outside a hatchling's cave.

Seeing the other dragons be kind reminded Enfys that he had seen them do this before!

Flint had used his strength to move boulders from a path to help the sheep pass to a higher field for spring.

Enfys had seen Slate using his height to help a lost hatchling back into its nest one summer too.

And last winter, Enfys remembered that he had also seen Ember using her warm breath to gently melt a frozen stream so the goats could drink.

Enfys suddenly realised they were being kind!

Just... secretly!

A small hope flickered in his chest. Maybe he wasn't the only dragon who felt soft inside after all.

Later, Enfys gently asked the bigger dragons, "Why do you tease me for being soft when you are so kind in secret?"

Flint shuffled his claws. Ember and Slate looked down.

Ember looked as red as her scales and said, "Dragons are supposed to be tough."

"If others see us being soft, they might laugh at us," Slate added.

Flint sighed. "It's easier to laugh first."

Enfys thought for a moment, then smiled.

"I think being kind is the bravest thing," he said.

After that day, the teasing grew quieter.



The bigger dragons helped in secret. Moving stones, bringing food, and fixing toys. Hoping no one would notice their gentle hearts.

The Council's Decision

One morning, a messenger dragon arrived. "The Dragon Council wishes to see you," he told Enfys.

Nervously, Enfys flew to the highest mountain peak. The wind was very strong up there, but Enfys didn't mind. He felt like a little white cloud floating toward the wisest dragons in the land.

The Elders sat around a glowing fire pit, their scales as hard as mountain stone. In the center of the circle sat a single, golden dragon egg. It was beautiful, but it was covered in tiny cracks.

"This is the heart of our treasure," the Grand Elder said. "It is very fragile.

We asked Flint to guard it, but his claws were too sharp.

We asked Ember, but her breath was too hot.

We also asked Slate, but his scales were too hard."

The Elder looked kindly at Enfys. "We need someone who is brave enough to be gentle. Enfys, can you keep the treasure

safe?”

Enfys stepped forward. His curls fluttered in the wind and his cheeks started to glow pink.

He didn't need sharp claws, hot fire or hard scales.

Instead, he lay down and tucked the golden egg deep into his soft, white, curly fur.

His gold tipped curls wrapped around the egg like a warm, springy blanket.

For the first time, the egg stopped shivering and it began to glow with a happy, golden light.

“Enfys,” said the Grand Elder, “we have watched you. You are brave, kind, and strong in ways many dragons are not.

Deep inside the mountain lies a vault filled with glowing gold.

We need a guardian who understands that the most precious things must be treated with kindness. And we choose you.”

Enfys' heart nearly burst with pride.

He bowed and promised to protect the treasure with all his might.

He realised his fur had never been a mistake. It had been his superpower all along.



In the glow of the fire, the Council told Enfys the truth they had always known. Only his gentle heart could protect the most precious treasure.

The Treasure with a Purpose

Enfys loved guarding the golden vault. The gold was shiny and wonderful, but as he sat in the quiet cave, he had a very important thought.

Gold was beautiful to look at, but kindness was worth even more.

He didn't want the treasure to simply sit in the dark. He wanted its glow to shine wherever it was needed most.

So every night, when the moon rose over the Fireback Mountains, Enfys would shake out his curls. Tiny specks of golden light drifted from the tips, like warm fireflies dancing in the air.

He became the Secret Helper of the Valley.

If a child was brave enough to try something new, like riding a bike or sleeping without a night light, Enfys would fly down quietly and leave a soft golden sparkle on their windowsill, as if to whisper, "I saw your courage."

If a child shared their last chocolate or helped a friend who had fallen, Enfys would land so softly that no one heard him at all. By morning, a gentle golden shimmer would glow nearby, reminding them that kindness makes the world brighter.

If someone told the truth even when it was hard, Enfys left a warm glimmer close by, so they would remember that honesty shines brighter than any treasure.

Enfys even visited the dragons on the mountain.

One night, he left a golden sparkle outside Flint's cave for helping the mountain sheep reach fresh grass.

He left one for Ember for warming the frozen stream, and one for Slate for fixing the broken toy of a crying hatchling.

The sparkles faded with the sunrise, but the warm feeling they left behind stayed much longer.

Soon, everyone on the mountain began looking for ways to help each other. And sometimes, if they were very lucky, they might see the shimmer of a white, curly dragon flying across the moonlit sky.

And even on mornings when no sparkle appeared, something had still changed. Each act of kindness left a tiny glow inside their hearts and made the valley shine.

And that was worth far more than gold.



Under the moonlit sky, Enfys scattered warm golden sparkles across the valley, whispering his thanks to those who had been brave and kind.

Dragons Can Change

As time passed, things on the mountain changed.

Flint, who was green and strong, stopped using his strength just to win races. Now, he used his powerful wings to fan the clouds away so the smaller dragons could sunbathe.

Ember, who was bright red and loud, didn't use her voice to shout anymore. Instead, she told the most wonderful bedtime stories, her voice crackling softly like a cosy campfire.

Slate, who was white and tall, used his height to reach the very best mountain berries for the hatchlings who couldn't fly that high yet.

Flint, Ember, and Slate teased less and didn't hide their kindness anymore.

Sometimes, you could see all four dragons, one with curly fur and three with shiny scales, sitting together on the highest peak.

They would watch the sun rise over the valley, and nobody felt the need to act "tough" or "scary."

Sometimes they helped Enfys guard the treasure. They learned how to be soft and gentle just like Enfys to keep the treasure safe.



Side by side beneath the mountain sky, the four dragons finally saw that their differences were the brightest part of them.

One evening, while the four friends sat together on the highest peak, Enfys felt a strange, rhythmic tapping against his chest.

Deep within his soft, white, curly fur, the golden egg was moving.

“Look!” Ember whispered, her voice as soft as a feather floating in the air.

The cracks that had once made the egg look fragile now glowed with a bright, happy light.

With a final pop, the shell fell away. Out tumbled the tiniest dragon the Fireback Mountains had ever seen.

The dragons gasped. The hatchling wasn’t covered in hard, cold scales.

Instead, from its nose to the tip of its tail, it was covered in tight, springy curls of pure, shimmering gold.

It looked just like a tiny, golden version of Enfys.

The little dragon shook out its curls, let out a small, smoky sneeze, and immediately wiggled back into Enfys’ white fur to stay warm.

“It’s beautiful,” Slate said softly, reaching out a claw to gently

pat the hatchling's head.

Enfys beamed, his heart glowing brighter than the gold in the vault.

He realised the Council hadn't just asked him to guard the egg because he was gentle, they knew that only someone with a heart like his could teach a new dragon how to be brave, kind, and perfectly itself.

Flint bumped his shoulder against Enfys' soft curls. "You were right, Enfys," he whispered. "Being kind is much more fun than being tough."

And deep in the mountain, the small dragon with curly golden tipped fur guarded the treasure with a warm heart and felt a happy glow in his chest.

He wasn't the "sheep with wings" anymore, he was the dragon who had taught the whole mountain how to love.

He still had his soft, white, curly fur, and it still shimmered gold in the sun.

He knew now that you don't need sharp scales to be a hero.

Sometimes the strongest dragons are small, and the toughest dragons are soft inside.

And being exactly who you are is the greatest treasure of all.



In the quiet glow of the cave, Enfys and his friends watched the golden hatchling emerge, their hearts shining as brightly as the new little dragon.



About the Author

Lauren E Matthews lives on a mountain in the Rhondda valley, where she spends her time looking for magic in everyday places.

Just like **Enfys**, Lauren believes that being kind is the bravest thing anyone can be.

When she isn't writing stories about dragons with curly fur, she loves writing poems, telling stories and going on adventures with her little dog **Llew** who is white and curly just like the hero of this book!

She hopes this book reminds you that being yourself is the greatest treasure of all!

You can connect with me on:

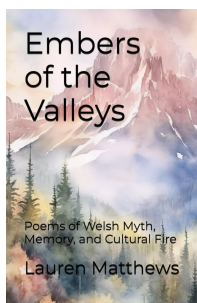
🌐 <https://www.laurenmatthews.co.uk>

Also by Lauren E Matthews

Lauren E Matthews is a lyrical storyteller and poet whose work is deeply rooted in the mythic soil of her homeland, Cymru. Born and raised in the heart of the Rhondda Valley, she draws inspiration from the rhythm of the hills and the ancient folklore of the land.

Whether she is unearthing the “hard, bright truths” of Welsh heritage in her poetry or exploring the magic of being yourself in her children’s stories, Lauren believes that magic can be discovered in everyday places, convinced that if you look hard enough, the world is still full of dragons.

When she isn’t writing about dragons with curly fur, Lauren can be found following the ancient paths of the valleys with her faithful companion, Llew, a white, curly dog who served as the real life inspiration for Enfyys.



Embers of the Valleys

A lyrical journey through the haunted beauty of Welsh history, folklore and resistance. Lauren E Matthews weaves poetry that burns with memory and myth. From the coal stained faces of the Tonypandy Riots to the spectral breath of Mari Lwyd, each poem is a reclamation of language, land and the stories buried beneath centuries of silence.

It honours the voices of Cymru, the women wrongly accused and those forged from bloom to the saints who walked the shore and the dragons who rose from the soil. Matthews writes with fierce tenderness, blending English and Cymraeg phrases and ancestral echoes into verse that is both intimate and epic.

Whether invoking the sorrow of Aberfan or the enchantment of Fan Fach, these poems do not merely retell, they remember and reimagine. They hum with hiraeth, the longing for a home that still speaks through stone and stream.



Echoes of the Kingdoms - Coming in 2026.

Echoes of the Kingdoms is a journey into the deep places of Cymru – the burial mounds, ironworks, drowned kingdoms and forgotten stories that shaped a nation long before history learned to write itself. In this companion to *Embers of the Valleys*, Lauren E Matthews turns inward, listening for the voices held in stone, soil, water and myth. These poems walk the long path between memory and legend, honouring ancient mothers, lost kingdoms, miners, rebels, goddesses and ghosts.

Rooted in cultural remembrance, this collection invites readers to step into the quiet, powerful spaces where the land itself speaks – and to hear the echoes that still rise from the old kingdoms beneath our feet.